

Overcalls

Because of the Defensive element, the most important requirement for an Overcall is that you have a good suit, one that you'd like partner to lead. Keep in mind:

- a 5-card or longer suit with honor strength

- 9-16 points to overcall at the 1-level

- 11-16 points to overcall at the 2-level

Takeout Doubles

There are three kinds of Takeout Double:

- opening hand strength, no more than 2 of opponent's suit, at least 3 in all other suits
- strong Overcall type, at least 17 points and a good suit. Double, then bid the suit.
- strong Notrump type, 19+ points, stopper in their suit. Double, then bid notrump.

Responding to a Takeout Double

- 0-8 points, bid your best suit as cheaply as possible

- 9-11 points, jump in your best suit

- 12 or more points, cue-bid the opponent's suit

Board: 1

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 2♣

Declarer: North

Lead: ♥K

Board: 2

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: East

Lead: ♣Q

Board: 3

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: South

Lead: ♠2

Board: 4

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: West

Lead: ♠4

Board 1

East Deals

None Vul

♠ A K J 9

♥ 10 9 8

♦ A 10 3

♣ Q 10 5

♠ 7 6 4 2

♥ 7 6 3

♦ 8 6 4

♣ J 9 8



♠ Q 10 8

♥ K Q 5

♦ 9 7 5 2

♣ A 6 3

♠ 5 3

♥ A J 4 2

♦ K Q J

♣ K 7 4 2

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

2♣

All Pass

2♣ by North

Lead: ♥K

1♠

Dbl

SOUTH has 14 points, a doubleton in the opponent's ♠ suit and at least three cards in each of the other suits. This is a normal Takeout Double.

NORTH has a really awful hand. He has just one point and his only 4-card suit is the one the opponents have already bid. He wants nothing more than to pass.

But he cannot pass. Partner's Double said "Bid your best suit.", so he bids 2♣.

Mercifully SOUTH also passes.

Board 2

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q 9 8 5
♥ K Q 10 5
♦ A K 3
♣ 4 2

♠ K 6

♥ 9 8 4 3

♦ 10 8 6

♣ K 10 7 6

	N	
W		E
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♠ A J 10 7

♥ J 7

♦ Q J 9 5

♣ A 8 3

♠ 4 3 2

♥ A 6 2

♦ 7 4 2

♣ Q J 9 5

With 14 points, ♣ shortage, and support for the other suits WEST makes a Takeout Double.

EAST has 13 points so she bids 2♣. This is an artificial bid, apprising WEST of EAST's opening hand strength, and forcing the partnership to reach the game level.

WEST suggests ♥s as trumps. EAST doesn't like ♥s so she suggests ♠s. WEST agrees with ♠s and bids game, 4♠.

West	North	East	South
			1♣
Dbl	Pass	2♣	Pass
2♥	Pass	2♠	Pass
4♠			
All Pass			
4♠ by East			
Lead: ♣Q			

Board 3

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 6 2
 ♥ A 10 8 4
 ♦ 10 8 2
 ♣ K J 4 2

♠ Q 7 4

♥ 9 6 5 2

♦ Q 5

♣ A 8 6 3



♠ 10 5

♥ K Q J 3

♦ 9 7 6 4

♣ Q 10 9

♠ A K J 9 8 3

♥ 7

♦ A K J 3

♣ 7 5

West	North	East	South
1 ♥	Pass	Pass	Dbl
Pass	2 ♣	Pass	2 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			
Lead: ♠ 2			

WEST's 1 ♥ opening is passed around to SOUTH.
 He is tempted to overcall 1 ♠, but with 18 points is a little strong for a mere overcall. Instead, he doubles.

With 8 points NORTH is not strong enough to jump.
 She bids 2 ♣.

SOUTH now bids 2 ♠. By doubling first, then bidding his own suit, he shows a good suit and 17+ points.

NORTH raises to 4 ♠.

Board 4

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ A J 9
 ♥ K Q 8
 ♦ Q 7 4
 ♣ A Q 8 5

♠ K 6 5 4

♥ J 10 4

♦ K 10 9

♣ J 10 2



♠ 8 7

♥ A 9 7 6

♦ A 6 2

♣ K 9 6 3

♠ Q 10 3 2

♥ 5 3 2

♦ J 8 5 3

♣ 7 4

WEST has 18 points, a balanced hand, and a good stopper in their suit. He should overcall 1NT. For 1NT overcalls, the range is increased to 15-18 points.

EAST bids 2♣ (Stayman), just as she would with a 1NT opening. When WEST denies holding a 4-card Major EAST has enough points to bid 3NT. She doesn't worry about a ♠ stopper since WEST promised he had the suit controlled.

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
1NT	Pass	2 ♣	Pass
2 ♦	Pass	3NT	
All Pass			
3NT by West			
Lead: ♠ 4			